Background for LOCF

- In clinical trials, we collect data at predetermined timepoints
- These predetermined timepoints are called visits
- Sometimes, the data could not be collected/reported at some visits for reasons like subject refused for a test or collected sample damaged etc.
- For analysis purposes, we may want to have all data available for each visit for all subjects
- One approach to fill in the missing data is to assume that result would have been the same as previous available collection/result
- This is technically called as 'last observation carried forward' and the newly 'filled' (created) record is called an imputed record/result
- We fill in the missing visits with the results from the previous available result

ADaM implementation

- CDISC ADaM standard allows for this kind of data imputation
- As per the standard, we can create new derived records within the parameter
- These new records have to be differentiated from the source records by populating the DTYPE variable
- The value in DTYPE variable has to be 'LOCF' if we are using the 'last observation carried forward' approach